

Verb + Preposition Reference

Dependent Prepositions — Comprehensive Table

Many English verbs are always followed by a specific preposition. There are no rules — these combinations must be learned as fixed pairs. The table below lists the most common verb + preposition combinations, with three example sentences for each preposition. Examples mix nouns, noun phrases, and verb-ing forms, since any of these can follow a preposition.

Preposition	Main verbs	Examples
for	apply for, wait for, pay for, apologise for, search for, ask for, look for, prepare for, hope for, thank (someone) for, blame (someone) for, care for.	1. They searched for a cheaper hotel . 2. She thanked him for helping . 3. Nobody wants to pay for someone else's mistake .
to	belong to, respond to, refer to, object to, look forward to, contribute to, listen to, reply to, react to, lead to, talk to, explain (something) to (someone).	1. The necklace belonged to her grandmother . 2. Poor diet often leads to health problems . 3. He objected to changing the schedule .
about	think about, talk about, worry about, complain about, dream about, forget about, ask about, hear about, know about, argue about, read about, learn about.	1. She often thinks about moving abroad . 2. We argued about the best approach . 3. I heard about the accident on the news.
on	depend on, rely on, concentrate on, insist on, spend (time/money) on, congratulate (someone) on, decide on, focus on, count on, comment on, agree on, work on.	1. You can always count on her . 2. He spends too much money on clothes . 3. They congratulated her on getting promoted .
in	believe in, succeed in, participate in, result in, specialise in, invest in, engage in, take part in, confide in, persist in.	1. She participated in the charity run . 2. The crash resulted in major delays . 3. He persisted in asking difficult questions .
from	suffer from, recover from, benefit from, prevent (someone) from, differ from, escape from, retire from, resign from, protect (someone) from, refrain from, hear from, borrow from.	1. Many people benefit from regular exercise . 2. She resigned from her position last month. 3. Nothing can protect you from the truth .
with	agree with (someone), deal with, cope with, argue with, provide (someone) with, compare with, struggle with, sympathise with, cooperate with, interfere with.	1. He refuses to cooperate with the police . 2. She compared the results with last year's data . 3. I sympathise with your situation .
of	consist of, accuse (someone) of, remind (someone) of, approve of, dream of, think of, smell of, hear of, inform (someone) of, get rid of, take advantage of.	1. The course consists of twelve modules . 2. This song reminds me of my childhood . 3. She took advantage of the opportunity .

Preposition	Main verbs	Examples
at	laugh at, look at, shout at, arrive at, stare at, point at, smile at, glance at, aim at, hint at, knock at.	1. He stared at the painting for a long time. 2. She smiled at the children playing outside. 3. They aimed at reducing costs by 20%.

Tips for learning:

Record new verbs together with their preposition as one chunk ("apply for", "depend on"). Group them by preposition when revising. Remember that when a verb-ing form comes after a preposition, it is never replaced by the infinitive — *look forward to seeing you*, not *look forward to see you*.